THE BEST IN DOING GOOD

In its 90th year, TISS drives its students from across India towards a richer understanding of society through fieldwork, conferences with experts and ideas-filled classrooms

By **SUHANI SINGH**

Ria Avinash Mhatra, a third-year bachelor's student of social work, lives only minutes away from the Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS), Mumbai, but the campus is her "second home"—one she prefers for its old-school vibe. Every Monday and Tuesday, she heads to a childcare institute to fulfil the course's fieldwork component. "Fieldwork exposed me to the realities of society," says Ria. "I was able to unlearn things and be more considerate of others' views."

Long known for its master's and PhD programmes, TISS has found new energy with BA and BSW (Bachelor of Social Work) students such as Ria. That energy is rubbing off on the faculty as well. "It allows us to think innovatively about our pedagogy and our engagement with students," says Bipin Jojo, dean of the TISS School of Social Work.

This shift has led to changes, including parent-teacher meetings and the use of podcasts and short-story writing as part of the teaching process. Faculty members are also encouraging the conscious

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"Our education and practice are rooted in innovation, service to marginalised communities, with interactive classrooms, professional skill-building and open student feedback shaping pedagogy"

BIPIN JOJO, *Dean, TISS School of Social Work*

